TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

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ORAL PRESENTATIONS

- Instance of public speaking:

SPEAKER > MESSAGE > AUDIENCE

- Frightening experience

- Fundamental skill

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

- **Verbal** + **paraverbal** + **nonverbal** communication:

I. Content > structure

II. Form > slides/posters/graphs/images (any visual aid)

III. Delivery > attitude, voice, interaction, self-management

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

- SPEAKER:
- knowledgeable, well-prepared, self-confident, charismatic
- relates to and interacts with the audience, informs, inspires and entertains
- AUDIENCE:
- attentive, curious, interested, empathic
- “follows”, supports, interacts with the speaker
- MESSAGE:
- structured, clear, attractive
- targeted specifically at the audience’s needs

STRUCTURING AN ORAL PRESENTATION

- INTRODUCTION

SUBJECT: *What is the subject of your presentation?*
OBJECTIVE/S: *What is/are the goal(s) of your presentation? (to inform, to prove, to convince, to change opinion, to bring a new perspective etc.)*
MAIN POINTS: *Which are the 3 main points you want to make? 1),* 2), 3)

- BODY

MAIN POINT 1
  - Supporting details/arguments/evidence *What supports your 1st point?*

MAIN POINT 2
  - Supporting details/arguments/evidence *What supports your 2nd point?*

MAIN POINT 3
  - Supporting details/arguments/evidence *What supports your 3rd point?*

- CONCLUSION: *What is your conclusion?*

STRUCTURING AN ORAL PRESENTATION

- Alex Lyon on how to organize a presentation (14.11 min) https://youtu.be/4bwDr7WVBwo
- Alex Lyon on attention grabbers (6.00 min) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ISn4Fip9aH8
- How to sound smart (5.55 min) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8S0FDjFBj8o

SHAPING AN ORAL PRESENTATION

- Designing > Drafting > Refining the layout:

  CLARITY, READABILITY, IMPACT
- Appropriate visual tools to support the message: graphs, tables, charts, pictures, videos, objects etc.
- Simple and well-chosen vocabulary to present the visual aids;
- Adaptability to the audience’s level of competence

SHAPING AN ORAL PRESENTATION

- Slides:
- Avoid stock templates;
- Keywords, NOT paragraphs;
- Font size for titles: 36-44 pt.;
- Font size for text: 24-28 pt.;
- Serif fonts (TNR, Garamond, Century, Lucida etc.);
- Sans Serif fonts (Verdana, Arial, Calibri, Helvetica etc.);
- Consistent use of bold/underlining/italics;
- Contrast between text and background;
- No more than 5 colours;
- No useless decorations.

To do

• Draft the **introduction** to a presentation on a technical/scientific subject of your choice observing the following structure:
1) Grab the audience's attention.
2) State the topic of your presentation.
3) Point out the benefits of listening to your presentation for the audience.
4) Talk about your credibility/ experience related to the topic.
5) Preview the three main points you will deal with in your presentation.
• Practise delivering the introduction to your presentation in **one minute**.

Resources

- Carnegie, D. (2008). *Cum să vorbim în public*. Bucureşti: Curtea Veche Publishing.
- Markel, M. (2012). *Technical Communication*. Boston/New York: Bedford/St. Martin's.
- Pfeiffer, W. S. and Adkins, K. E. (2012). *Technical Communication Fundamentals*. New Jersey: Prentice Hall.
- Powell, M. (2008). *In Company: Upper Intermediate. Student's book.* Macmillan.
- How to Make a Good PowerPoint Presentation https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=grJ0FbpfvOw
- https://visage.co/11-design-tips-beautiful-presentations/
- https://www.chillibreeze.com/presentation-design/everything-you-need-to-know-about-powerpoint-formatting/